Procedure

for

Knowledge Management

Author(s)	
Signed By: *Kalyanaraman, Subha*	Name (EID): Kalyanaraman, Subha (245610) Designation: Manager - Projects Vertical: CIO Global Engineering & Ops Date: 25-Feb-2025 16:30:24 (UTC + 5.30) Remarks: Authored

Reviewer(s)	
Signed By: *Shekar, Santosh*	Name (EID): Shekar, Santosh (716597) Designation: Assoc. Director - Projects Vertical: CIO Global Engineering & Ops Date: 07-Mar-2025 19:58:54 (UTC + 5.30) Remarks: Reviewed

Approver(s)	
Signed By: *Narayanamurthy, Praveen*	Name (EID): Narayanamurthy, Praveen (734441) Designation: Senior Director Vertical: CIO Global Engineering & Ops Date: 10-Mar-2025 11:28:58 (UTC + 5.30) Remarks: Approved

Table of Contents

1.0 Overview 5
1.1 Objective 5
2.0 Scope 5
2.1 Vision 5
2.2 Scope of Applicability 5
2.3 Out of Scope 5
3.0 Roles and Responsibilities 5
3.1 RACI Matrix – IT Support, Known Error and Corporate IT – User Self-Service 8
3.2 RACI Matrix – Process Space 9
4.0 Knowledge Management Considerations 11
4.1 Triggers 11
4.2 Pre-Requisites 11
5.0 Best Practices 11
5.1 Knowledge Creation 11
5.2 Approving Knowledge 12
5.3 Avoid the Creation of Duplicates 12
5.4 Maintaining Knowledge Categories 12
5.5 Improving Knowledge 12
6.0 Knowledge Management Procedure 13
6.1 Knowledge Creation 13
6.1.1 IT Support, Known Error and Corporate IT – User Self-service Knowledge Base 16
6.1.2 Process Space Knowledge Base 21
6.2 Knowledge Maintenance – All Knowledge Bases 28
6.2.1 Providing Knowledge Feedback 28
6.2.2 Responding to Knowledge Feedback Tasks 30
6.2.3 Performing Article Quality Index (AQI) 32
6.2.4 Notifications 32
6.3 Knowledge Retirement – All Knowledge Bases 34
7.0 Additional Features 35
7.1 Adding a knowledge article to Featured Content 35
7.2 Finding and Using within the Incident form 36
7.3 Finding and Using within Problem form 37
7.4 Finding and Using within Change form 38
7.5 Knowledge Search 39
7.6 Reports and Dashboards 41
7.7 Creating a new Knowledge Base 42
8.0 Acronyms 42

9.0 Definitions 43

10.0 Change Log 44

1.0 Overview

1.1 Objective

The purpose of this procedure document is to detail the specific steps that must be completed by distinct roles in the performance of the IT Knowledge Management process.

This document is an asset to Knowledge Management practitioners and those from other processes who interface with the Knowledge Management process. These procedures provide uniform and consistent methods of operation.

2.0 Scope

2.1 Vision

This document describes the Knowledge Management procedural flow that is required to follow/adhere/align to the process defined as per the process document (Link)

2.2 Scope of Applicability

This procedure document is applicable for all document lifecycle stages - Creation, review, approval, maintenance, publication, and retirement for IT Support, Known Error, Corporate IT – User Self-Service and Process Space KB

2.3 Out of Scope

This procedure document refers to the IT Knowledge Management process within IT. Activities related to the platform team are out of the scope of this document.

3.0 Roles and Responsibilities

This section covers the roles and responsibilities within the IT Knowledge Management process:

Role	Responsibilities
Process Owner	• Defines the KM process and procedure and ensures they are adopted across all service lines. • Establishing and communicating the process mission, goals, and objectives to all stakeholders • Ensure the defined process is in line with the organizational standards. • Developing and maintaining the Knowledge Management process and procedure • Creates, maintains, and approves the knowledge templates • Driving the efficiency and effectiveness of the Knowledge Management process and procedure • Continually monitoring the process and identifying opportunities for improving the process • Monitoring and improving knowledge articles • Defines, review, and report the KPIs periodically to the leadership.
Knowledge Manager	• Responsible for the execution of the process (directly perform or delegate responsibilities) • Resolving cross-functional issues for process design and execution • Setting targets and reviewing the effectiveness and efficiency of the process • Performing process audits and managing the process improvement cycle • Responsible for the operational management of the process • Responsible for the quality of process execution and the reporting on progress and results • Creates and maintains knowledge bases and templates • Approve or reject the knowledge articles • Allocating support resources and ensuring the resources are sufficiently trained to execute their roles • Ensures that the process, roles, responsibilities, and documentation are regularly reviewed • Initiate Continual Improvement activities • Perform Gap Analysis, Review KPIs, and takes any required action following the analysis • Report to stakeholders about process improvement recommendations
Knowledge Management Coordinator	• Executes the Knowledge Management process activities and maintains the knowledge for a functional area(s) of the organization • Responsible for coordinating process activities • Perform administrative functions for knowledge bases they manage • Defining categories, pinning important articles, approving changes to articles, and managing knowledge bases

Ownership Group Manager/Approver	• Approve/Reject the knowledge Article • Review the flagged articles report on quality audits, article expiry, and feedback and determine if the articles need to be updated, retired, or republished. • Perform periodic reviews of the knowledge base content to ensure its usefulness and relevancy • Approve/Reject the retirement of a knowledge article
Knowledge Management Contributor/Author	• Create / Modify knowledge articles • Republish/Retire as per the actions informed
Knowledge Management Consumer	• Ability to read knowledge articles • Uses knowledge in day-to-day activities • Provides feedback on existing knowledge • Identifies and report missing knowledge needed in day-to-day activities • Identifies knowledge that needs to be updated

Below roles are additional roles specific to Process Space Knowledge Base.

Governance Team/ Knowledge Manager	• Review the knowledge article to confirm whether the attributes are appropriate • Identify/edit attributes, reviewers & approvers • Ensure proper branding is practiced while creating articles • Approve or reject the knowledge article • Publish knowledge article
Knowledge Owner	• First-level review and approval of the Published/New documents.
Reviewer	• Perform the first level of content review where the domain-specific details are validated
Approver	• Perform the second level of content review to confirm appropriate details are captured in domain aspects
Quality Analyst	• Perform quality audits to evaluate the quality of the articles

3.1 RACI Matrix – IT Support, Known Error and Corporate IT – User Self-Service

Process	Sub Processes	KM Process Owner	Knowledge Manager	KM Coordinator	Ownership Group Manager	Ownership Group Team	KM Contributor	Problem Coordinator	PM Owner	Problem Manager	Incident Manager	Incident Analyst
Knowledge Creation	Determine the type of Knowledge Base and Knowledge Article template			C			R					
	Create/Update Knowledge Article			C	A		R					
	Create/Update Known Error Record		I					R		A		
	Draft Knowledge article from Incident record (Where no articles will not be found in search)		I								A	R
	Review Knowledge Item				R		A					
	Approving/Rejecting for publishing		I		R	I	A/I					
Knowledge Maintenance	Creating and managing a knowledge base to maintain the information about known errors and workarounds	R							I			
	Consume Article during incident										A	R

	Resolution										
	Analyze Known Error reports		I					A	R		
	Distribute consolidated reports on flagged articles	A	R	I							
	Review consolidated report on flagged articles	I		A	R						
	Decide on Update/Retire		C	A	R	I	I				
	Initiate retirement request				A	R		A (known Errors)			
Knowledge Retirement	Perform Impact Analysis				R	I					
	Approval / Rejection of retirement		I		R	I	A/I				

3.2 RACI Matrix – Process Space

Process	Sub Processes	Knowledge Owner	Governance Team	Ownership Group Manager	Ownership Group Team Member	Reviewers	Approvers	Knowledge Author
	Published Documents (Documents already published in QMS Process Space)							
Knowledge Creation	Create New Knowledge Article		C, I	A	C, I			R
	Update source and attributes	C	C, I	A, C	C, I			R
	Submit for Review and approval	I	A, C	C, I	C, I	C, I	C, I	R

Process	Sub Processes	Knowledge Owner	Governance Team	Ownership Group Manager	Ownership Group Team Member	Reviewers	Approvers	Knowledge Author
	Review and approve	I	A, R	C	C		R	C, I
	Publish the article	I	A, R	I	I			I
	New Document (either in an external Word/Excel/PPT template or directly in the Content field in ServiceNow)							
	Create New Knowledge Article		C, I	A	C, I			R
	Update source and attributes	C	C, I	A, C	C, I			R
	Submit for Review and approval	I	A, C	C, I	C, I	C, I	C, I	R
	Review and approve (Attributes)		A, R	I	I			I
	Review and approve (Content)		I	A	R	R	R	C, I
	Final review and approval (Pre-publication)		A, R	I	I			I
	Publish article	I	A, R	I	I	I	I	I
Knowledge Maintenance	Initiate periodic review		A, R	R	R			R
	Periodic review		C	A, I	R, I			R
	Determine whether to update/retire	I	C, I	A, R	C, I			C, I
Knowledge Retirement	Perform Impact analysis		A, R	C, I	C, I			C, I
	Approval/rejection		A, R	R	C, I			I
	Retire knowledge article	I	A, R	I	I			I

4.0 Knowledge Management Considerations

4.1 Triggers

For creating new articles

- New incident, known error or service request is identified
- Go-live of a new application or service or catalog
- New policy, process, or procedure documentation must be created
- Creation of new standard operating procedures
- Creation of new self-help articles for end-users

For updating existing articles

- Changes to an application or service or catalog
- Changes to existing operating procedures, policies, or processes
- Changes to existing self-help articles
- New application/service release that may impact other upstream and downstream applications/services
- Update known error articles with the root cause and implemented solution
- Article Expiry
- Feedback and quality checks

4.2 Pre-Requisites

Listed below are the pre-requisites for performing activities and procedures in Knowledge Management:

- ServiceNow Knowledge module access
- Knowledge of ITSM ServiceNow tool
- Access to Knowledge Management process documentation
- Knowledge of the Knowledge Management process.
- All information required to create or approve an article

5.0 Best Practices

5.1 Knowledge Creation

Before knowledge creation, the contributor should reach out to functional teams that have been involved with the knowledge trigger and ask them to provide any necessary information. They should also refer to existing knowledge articles on similar topics. The naming convention of knowledge articles provides a clear taxonomy that allows users to easily identify and consume the information

they require. The below points must be kept in mind before creating an article.

- Knowledge articles should be chunks of information and easy to consume
- The structuring of articles should be simplistic.
- Add relevant keywords to ease the search functionality and overall consumption of articles
- Utilize templates to maintain article structure

5.2 Approving Knowledge

The knowledge article is reviewed and approved to ensure the below parameters are taken into consideration before publishing the article.

- Selection of topic - Is this article relevant? Is any other article covering the same topic?
- Technical Correctness
- Logical flow and completeness of instructions
- Language, spelling, and grammar
- Correctness of title and keywords

5.3 Avoid the Creation of Duplicates

Search for existing knowledge articles should be done before creating a new one. The below points can be noted to avoid duplication.

- Correct use of tags, naming convention, and categorization
- Effective governance over the knowledge management process allows KM teams to understand topics that are used most, and identify duplicates, if any
- Periodic review and maintenance of knowledge articles

5.4 Maintaining Knowledge Categories

Each knowledge base will have categories with optional sub-categories

- Keep It Short & Simple (“KISS”) Principle - Simplicity should be a key goal in system design, and unnecessary complexity should be avoided. This applies when naming and building the categorization
- No more than 8-10 categories - By minimizing the number of sub-categories, our goal is to reduce complexity and have an ITSM product that can be understood by the support teams
- No more than 12-15 subcategories per category - By minimizing the number of sub-categories, our goal is to reduce complexity and have an ITSM product that can be understood by the support teams
- Focus on Auto-Escalations - Categories and sub-categories for mature organizations should be used for auto-escalations
- Better reporting supports continuous improvement - Categorization enables better reporting and causal analysis enabling continuous improvement.

5.5 Improving Knowledge

- Provide Feedback and Rate Articles

Feedback for knowledge articles can be submitted in the following ways:

- Flag an article as incorrect or inappropriate.
- Provide a rating value for the article.
- Mark an article as helpful or not helpful.

- View comments, add a new comment or reply to existing comments.

The availability of these various feedback options to users can be configured within the system.

- Knowledge Feedback Tasks

Manage high volumes of article feedback by enabling task generation for negative feedback. When an article is rated poorly or marked as unhelpful, a feedback task is generated and assigned to the author or reviser of the article.

- Ownership Groups

When knowledge articles are created, ownership groups can be associated with them. Ownership groups manage article approvals and feedback and can edit and retire knowledge articles that they are associated with.

Knowledge group managers can edit ownership groups managed by them, by adding or removing members without the need for approval. It also helps create an ownership group from an existing group.

- Knowledge Base Q&A

If Social Q&A is activated for a knowledge base, you can ask questions and respond to questions from other users. All questions and answers are associated with a knowledge base. Social Q&A uses knowledge access controls, search, and the knowledge homepage.

Questions appear along with knowledge articles organized by knowledge base, category, and tags. Click on a question to view the question details, responses, and comments.

6.0 Knowledge Management Procedure

6.1 Knowledge Creation

Knowledge articles can be created and updated within a knowledge base to share information across the organization. There are mainly four knowledge bases that are in scope for IT. Knowledge Manager/Ownership Group Manager/Knowledge Contributor/Coordinator can create knowledge articles and they can create only for their assigned ownership group.

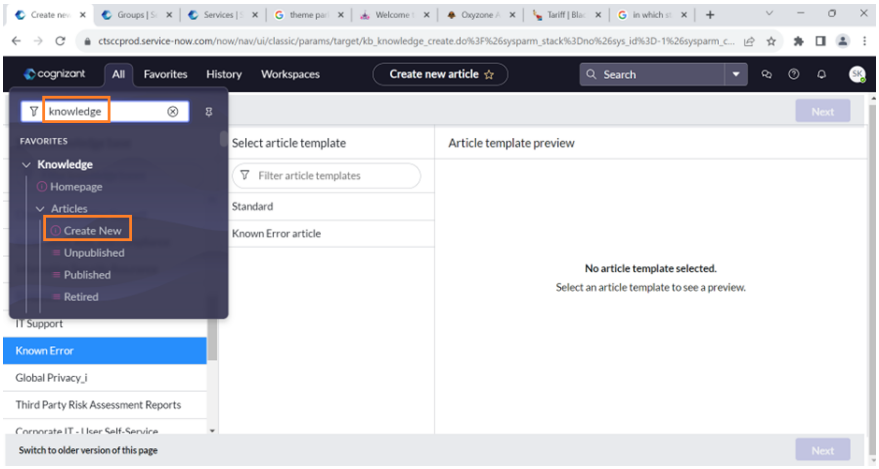
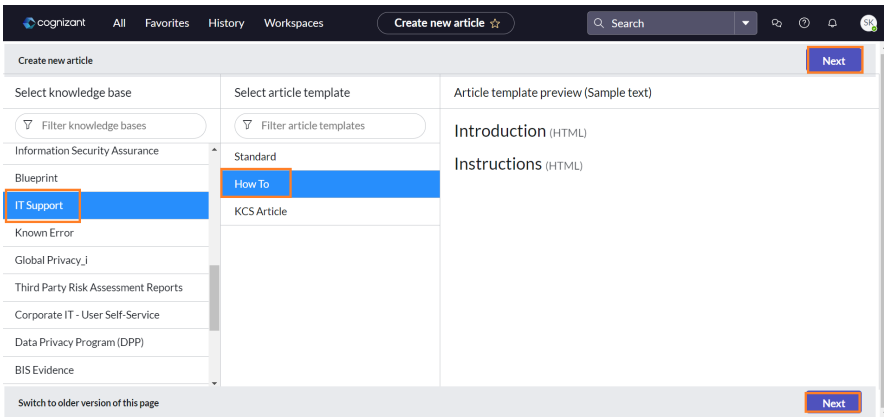
ID	Knowledge Base	Knowledge Base Description	Knowledge Templates
1	IT Support	IT Support knowledge base consists of articles that are specifically designed for IT Support personnel to resolve incidents and service requests	KCS Article, How To
2	Known Error	This knowledge base will hold all the known error articles created for problem management and will be accessed by the IT Support personnel	Known Error article
3	Process Space	This knowledge base is a repository of IT Policies, standards, processes, procedures, manuals, guidelines, templates, checklists, etc. that are used in the delivery of IT services within Cognizant. These documents are a replica of the ones available in Process Space application and they are available in ServiceNow for ease of use.	Process Space
4	Corporate IT – User	This knowledge base consists of all articles that	KCS Article, How

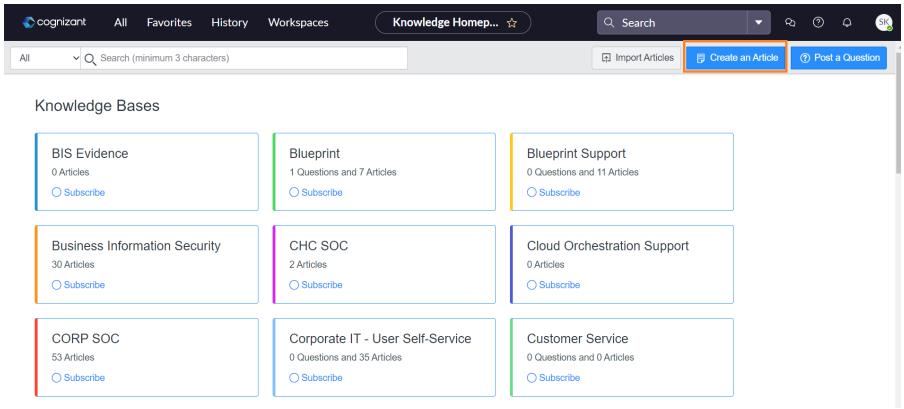
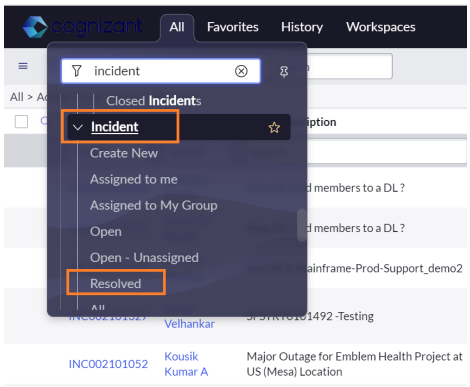
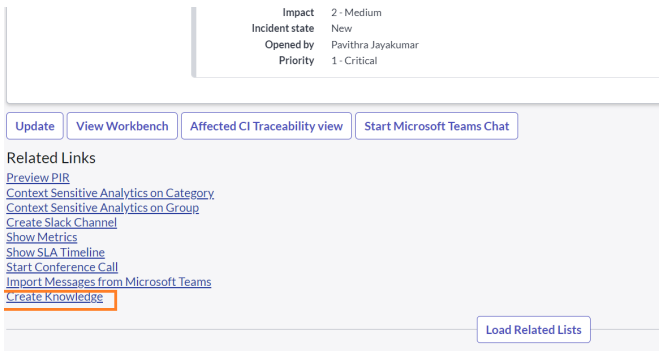
	Self-service	users can consume directly as self-service, such as user guides, procedures for self-help, etc.	To

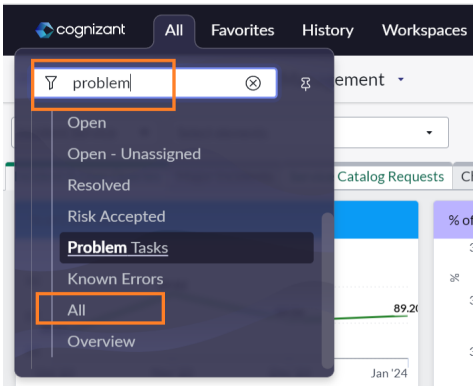
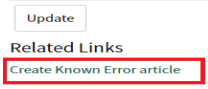
The knowledge can either be created from any of the transactions – incident, problem or change, or by manually selecting the appropriate knowledge repository and the template to represent the knowledge.

The need for knowledge to be documented is identified through a variety of sources.

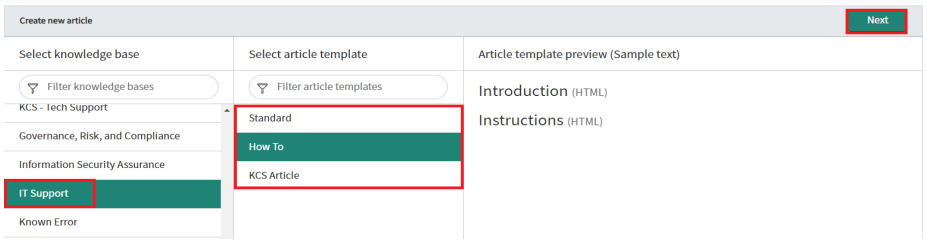
- External / Internal knowledge requirements
- Need for documenting processes, procedures, workarounds, known errors, policies, standards, etc.
- Article expiry
- Article feedback
- Quality checks

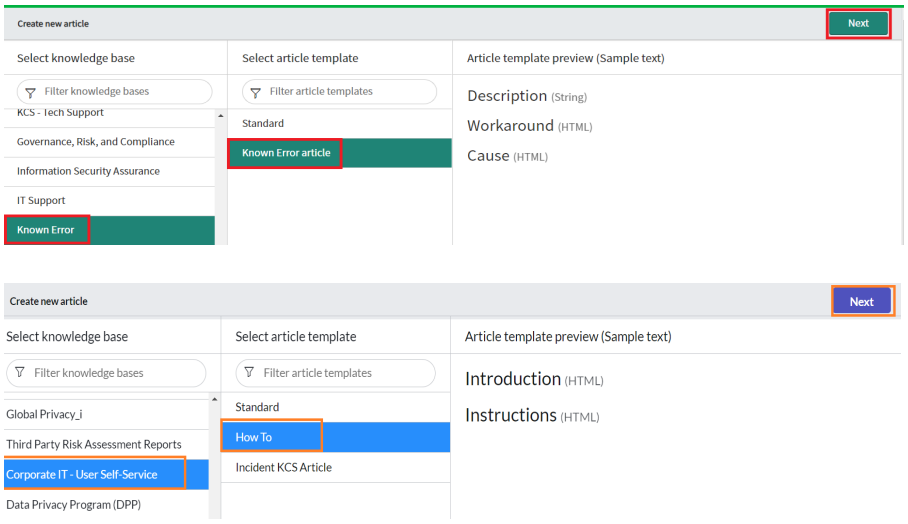
Sl No.	Options	Activity
1	From Navigation Page	Log in to the Service Now tool using Single Sign-on and navigate to the **Knowledge** module and click on **Create New** under Articles  Select the knowledge base, template and click on Next, either at the top or bottom of the screen. 

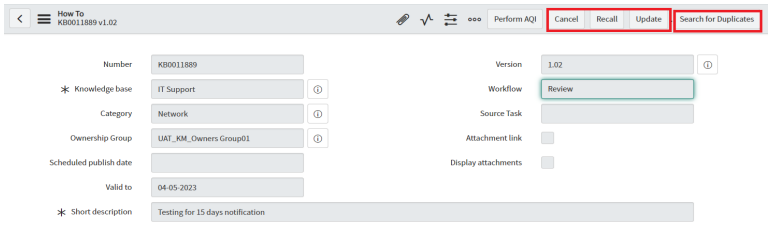
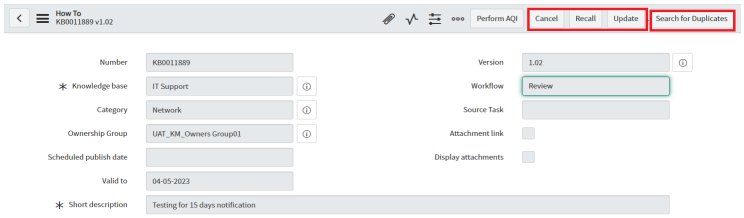
2	From Home page	Type **Homepage** in the navigation bar and click on **Homepage** under Knowledge Click on **Create an article** at the top right corner 
3	From Incident form	Type **Incident** in the navigation search bar and click on **Resolved** under **Incident**  Open any incident and and scroll down. Click on **Create Knowledge**. 
4	From Problem form	Type **Problem** in the navigation search bar and click on **All** under **Problem**

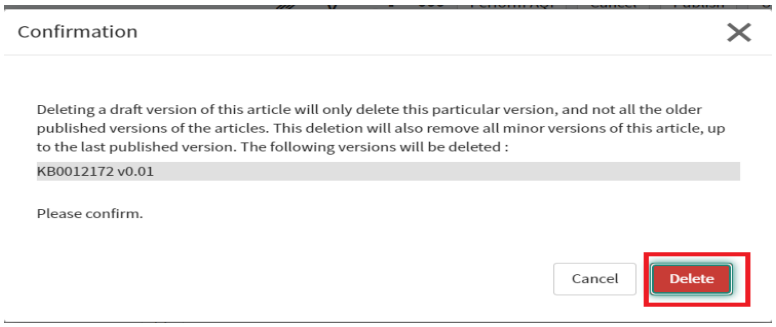
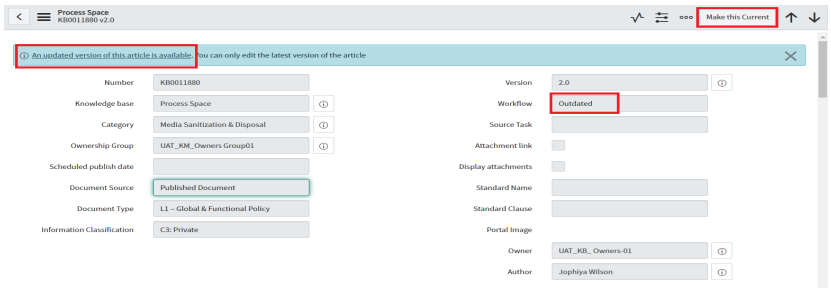
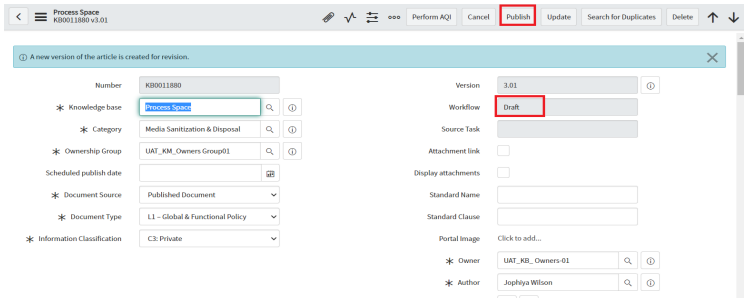
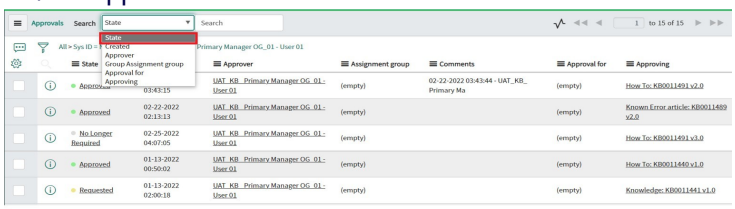
		 Open any **Problem record** and scroll down. There will be an option **Create a Known Error** 
5	From Change form	Post-change implementation, the change implementor will have to navigate to the knowledge module to create an article based on implemented changes

6.1.1 IT Support, Known Error and Corporate IT – User Self-service Knowledge Base

S. No.	Activity	Owner	State
1	Log in to the Service Now tool using Single Sign-on and navigate to the Knowledge module and click on **Create New** under Articles	Knowledge Contributor	Draft
2	Select the appropriate Knowledge Base and respective template formats • IT Support – Standard/How To/KCS • Known Error - Known Error • Corporate IT – User Self-service Navigate to the right end and click **Next** to display the different fields to be populated by the user 	Knowledge Contributor	Draft

S. No.	Activity	Owner	State
			
3	Fill in all the fields listed below • Select the **Category** and **Subcategory** by clicking on the lens icon next to the field from Category Picker Box • Select the **Ownership group** by clicking on the Lens icon next to the field • **Scheduled Publish Date,** Date in the future when the article is to be published • **Valid to**, this field will be defaulted to one year from the date of creation • **Short description**, type in a high-level overview of the description that users may want to search for • **Workflow**, this field will represent the state of the knowledge article • **Source Task**, the ticket from which the knowledge article was created (e.g., INC, PRB, CHG) • **Attachment Link,** Option for downloading an attached file automatically when a user accesses the article, instead of opening the article view • **Display Attachments,** Option for displaying attachments to users viewing this knowledge article • **META,** keywords that can make the search easier **How To Template** • **Introduction,** brief introduction about the article • **Instructions,** instructions on how to complete a task **KCS template** • **Issue,** the issue is described in the requestor's way explaining what is not working • **Environment,** product names, versions, or processes • **Cause,** the underlying cause of the issue • **Resolution,** the answer, or the steps taken to resolve the issue **Known Error Template** • **Description,** describing the overall issue faced • **Workaround** describes a temporary solution for the issue until a permanent solution is found	Knowledge Contributor	Draft

S. No.	Activity	Owner	State
	• **Cause,** describe what caused the issue After filling in all the mandatory and relevant fields, click **Submit** to create the Knowledge Article		
4	Fill in all the mandatory fields and draft the article. Click **Submit** to save the draft and the article ID will be generated	Knowledge Contributor	Draft
5	Click on **Publish** so that the approval workflow will be triggered **A notification is triggered to the approver, copying the author, once the article is routed for approval.**	Knowledge Contributor	Draft
6	The author at this stage will also have options to **Cancel, Recall, Update** and **Search for Duplicates.** These options can be performed by both the **Author** as well as **Approver**  **Cancel**, Once the author clicks on Cancel, the article workflow state is automatically changed to **Cancelled** **Recall**, If the article needs to be edited, after submitting for review, click on **Recall.** Once the author/approver clicks on **Recall**, the article will move back to the draft state. The author can make the necessary changes/edits, and click on **Update**. **Update** is a general feature to update the article if any changes are made and this option is available until the article is Published. The update option will not change the state of the article **Search for duplicates**, when the user clicks on **Search for Duplicates**, he/she will be navigated to a different window with articles with a similar short description  **Delete**, Clicking on Delete will show up a pop-up box asking for confirmation before deleting, and once confirmed the article will be deleted permanently and will not be viewable for the users.	Knowledge Contributor /Approver	Draft/ Review

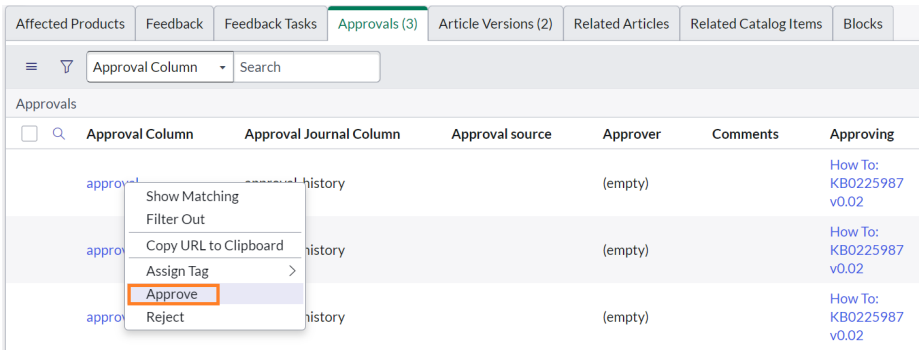
S. No.	Activity	Owner	State
	 For an **Outdated** article, click on **Make this as current** or **the pop-up in blue** and the article will be moved to the draft state and the user can make the necessary changes if required and initiate the publishing workflow  		
7	Navigate to the left pane and type Approvals and Select **My Approvals** under Service Desk once the approval workflow is triggered.	Ownership Group Managers	Review
8	Select **State** from the dropdown and type **Requested** and search for requested items. The Approver will be able to view the article requested for his/her approval 	Ownership Group Managers	Review
9	Articles can be approved in 2 different ways. 1. From the **Related List** on the article form Click on the **Knowledge article Number** and you will be directed to the	Ownership Group Managers	Review

S. No.	Activity	Owner	State

article form

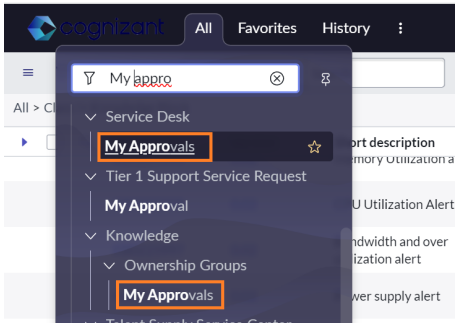
Scroll to the bottom of the form and click on **Load Related Lists**

Click on **Approvals** tab, right click on the approval item and click on **Approve**

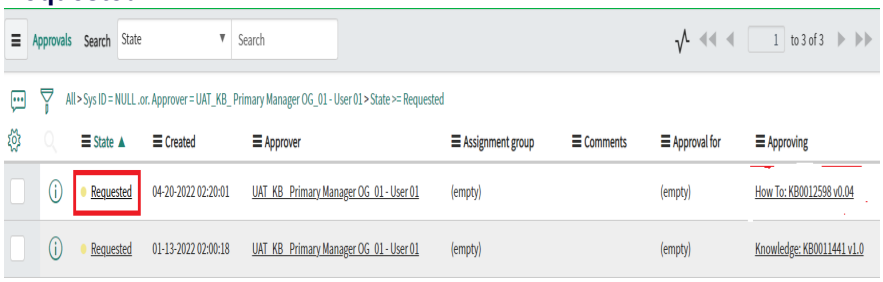


The approver can approve/reject as per the above screenshot

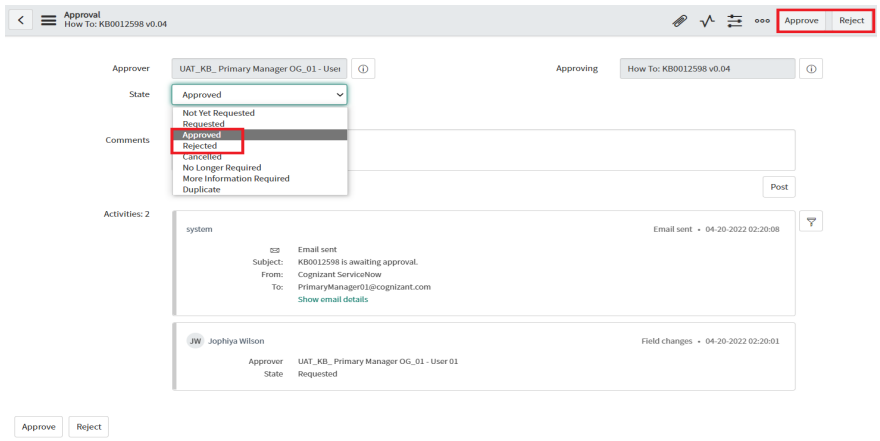
2. From the **My Approvals module,** by searching for approval in the navigator



The list of items that is waiting for your approval would be listed. Click on **Requested** from the list view



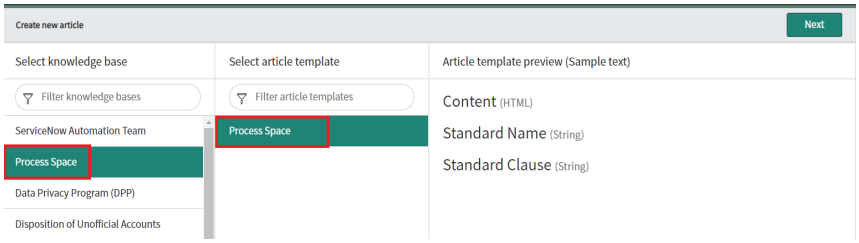
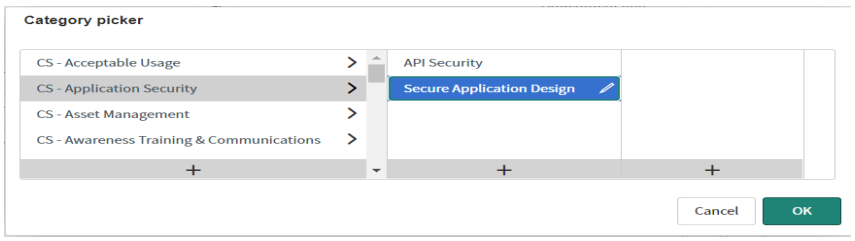
The approver will be able to see the below screen with **Approve/Reject** options

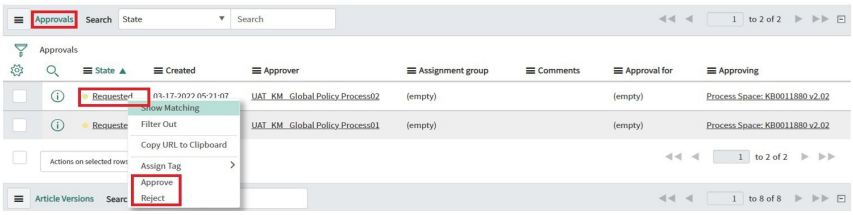
S. No.	Activity	Owner	State
	 Select **Approved / Rejected** from the dropdown and click on **Approve / Reject. Comments** can also be added if required. **A notification is triggered to the ownership group so that they are aware this article is published.**		
10	Click on **Approve** if the article needs to be Published. The article will be published immediately if the **Scheduled Publish Date** is not filled. If the **Scheduled Publish date** is filled in, the article will be published only on the mentioned date. **A notification is triggered to the approver, as a reminder, copying the author. This case is specific if the article is scheduled for publication, and the publish date is approaching, but the approver has not yet approved the article. Notifications will be sent starting one week before the scheduled published date**	Ownership Group Managers	Review
11	If the approver wants to Reject the article, click on **Requested** from the approval list (from step 9)	Ownership Group Managers	Review
12	Select **Rejected**, from the dropdown in the **State** field, add rejection comments and then click on **Reject.** The article will move to the **Draft** state **A notification is triggered to the author along with the rejection comm ents**	Ownership Group Managers	Draft

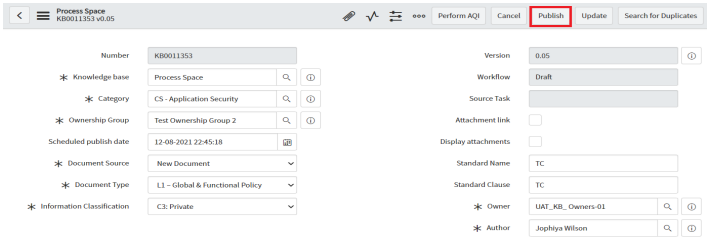
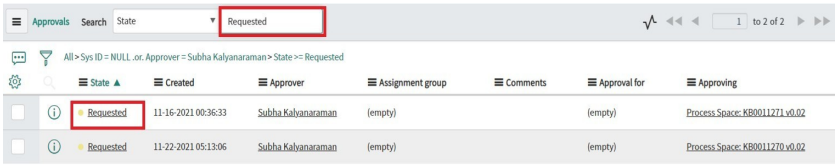
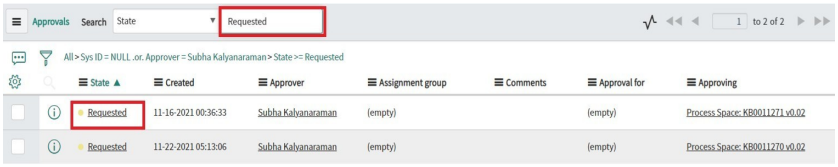
6.1.2 Process Space Knowledge Base

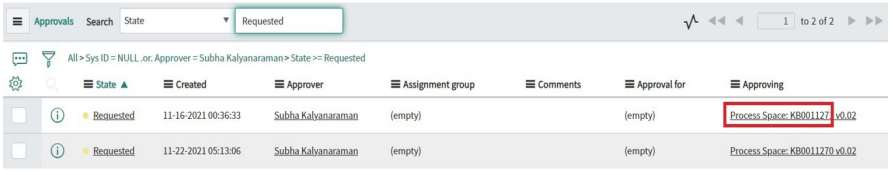
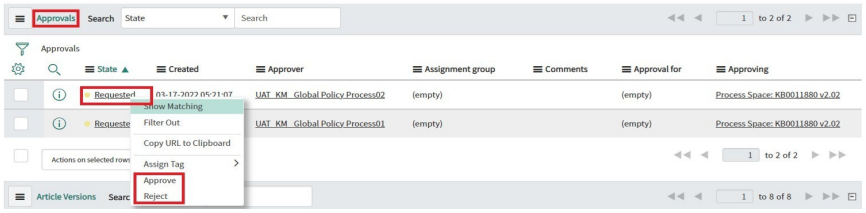
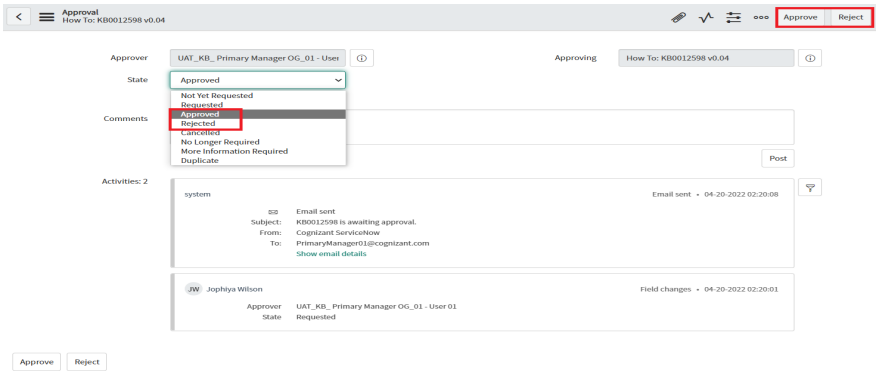
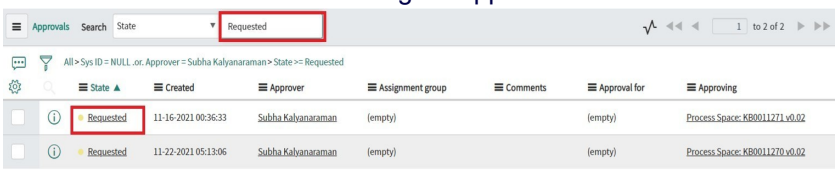
The Process Space knowledge base is a repository of IT Policies, Standards, Processes, Procedures, Manuals, Guidelines, Templates, and Checklists which is used in the delivery of IT services within Cognizant

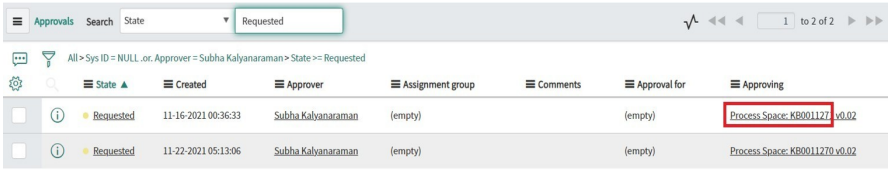
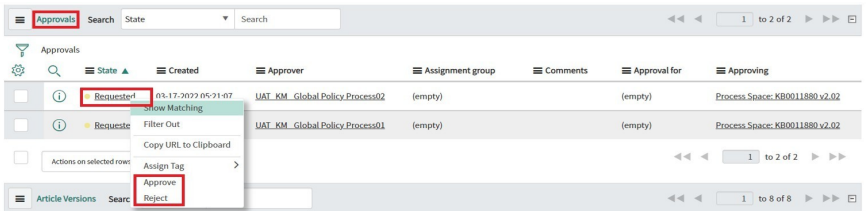
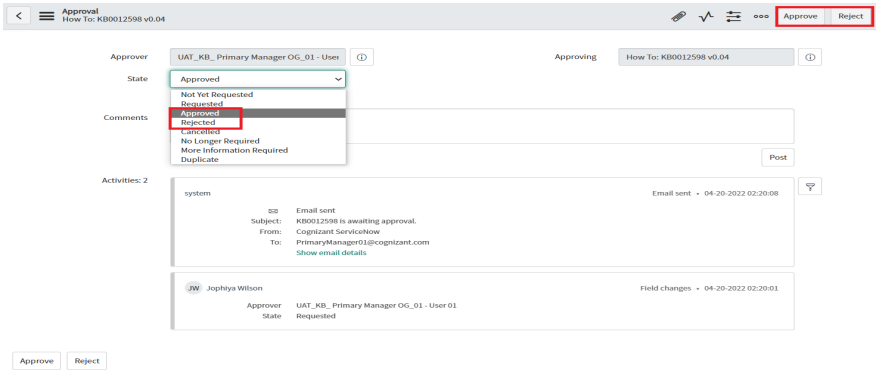
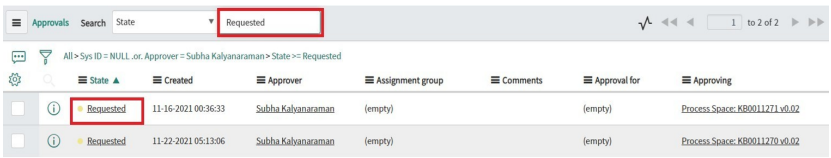
S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
1	• Log in to Service Now tool using Single Sign-on and click on **Create New** under the Knowledge module and select the Process	Knowledge Contributor	Draft

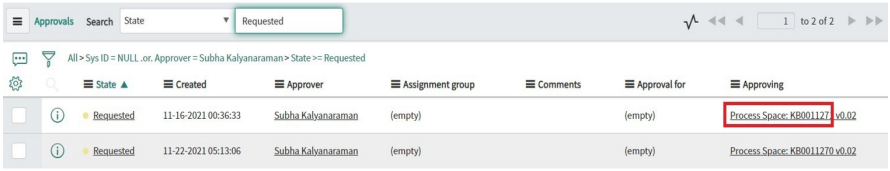
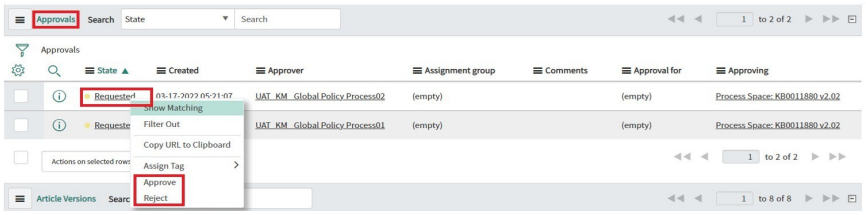
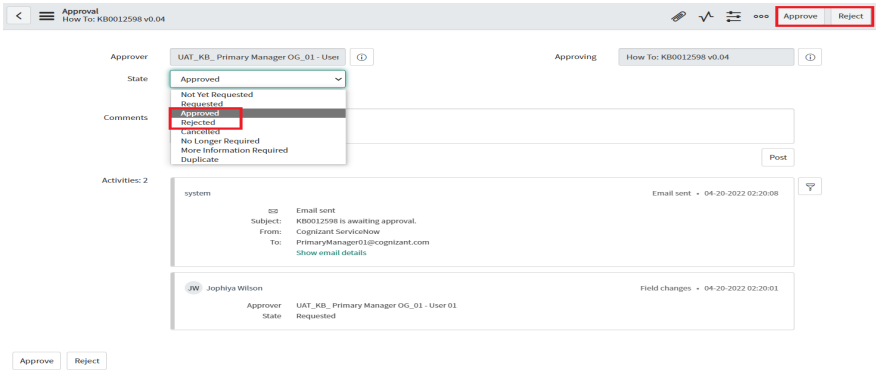
S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
	Space Knowledge Base • Select the Process Space Template • Navigate to the right end and click on **Next**  		
2	**Scenario 1 – Published Document** Fill in all the below fields • Subcategories can be selected from the below **Category Picker** Box  • Select the **Ownership group** by clicking on the lens icon next to the field • **Schedule for Publish,** this field can be used in case the article needs to be published later • Select the **Document source** – **Published Document** from the drop-down next to the field. If the selection is New Document, the content field will be auto-populated. • Select the **Document Type**– L1/L2/L3/L4 from the drop-down next to the field • **Information Classification** represents the Information Security Information Classification. By default, it will be updated as **C3; Private** but this field is editable • Enter the S**hort Description** • Enter the relevant details in the **Content** field • **Standard Name**, enter the Type of Standard - ISO 20000 / ISO 27000 / etc., • **Standard Clause**, enter the Clause of Standard - Section 1, Clause 1 / Section 1.1 / 1.1.1 • Select the **Owners** by clicking on the lens icon next to the field. • Select the **Author** by clicking on the lens icon next to the field. • **Reviewer**, a multi-select field. The author can select more than one reviewer. • **Approver,** a multi-select field. Approver will review and approve the document. The author can select more than one approver • After filling in all the mandatory and relevant fields, click **Submit** to create the Knowledge Article • The article ID will be generated and the article is available in Draft	Knowledge Contributor	Draft

S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
	state		
3	Click on **Publish** so that the approval workflow will be triggered and article is sent for approval	Knowledge Contributor	Draft
4	Navigate to the left pane and type **Approvals** and Select **My Approvals** under **Service Desk**	Governance Team	Review
5	Select the **State** from the dropdown and type **Requested** in the search bar and click **Enter**. The article waiting for approval will be listed down	Governance Team	Review
6	Click on the knowledge article and you will be directed to the article form. Scroll down to the **Approval tab** under **Related Lists**  The approver can either approve from the list view page by clicking on **Requested** (Right click – screenshot in the 5th step) or can approve from **Approvals** tab under **Related List** in the article form (above screenshot)	Governance Team	Review
7	Knowledge article will be published automatically, once approved, if the **Scheduled Publish Date** field is not filled in	NA	Published
8	**Scenario 2 – New Document** Fill in the mandatory fields listed below • Subcategories can be selected from the **Category Picker** Box • Select the **Ownership group** by clicking on the lens icon next to the field • **Schedule for Publish,** this field can be used in case the article needs to be published later • Select the **Document Source** – **New Document** from the drop-down next to the field. If the selection is New Document, the content field will be auto-populated. • Select the **Document Type**– L1/L2/L3/L4 from the drop-down next to the field • **Information Classification** represents the Information Security Information Classification. By default, it will be updated as C3; Private but this field is editable • Enter the **short description** • Enter the relevant details in the **Content** field • **Standard Name**, enter the Type of Standard - ISO 20000 / ISO 27000 / etc., • **Standard Clause**, enter the Clause of Standard - Section 1, Clause 1 / Section 1.1 / 1.1.1 • Select the **Owner** by clicking on the Lens icon next to the field. • Select the **Author** by clicking on the Lens icon next to the field. • **Reviewer**, a multi-select field. The author can select more than	Knowledge Contributor	Draft

S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
	one reviewer. • **Approver,** a multi-select field. Approver will review and approve the document. The author can select more than one approver • After filling in all the mandatory and relevant fields, click **Submit** to create the Knowledge Article • Fill in all the fields and Click **Submit** to save the draft, post which the article ID will be generated		
9	Select the Knowledge Article number from the list view and you will be directed to the article form. Click on **Publish** so that the approval workflow will be triggered 	Knowledge Contributor	Draft
10	Navigate to the left pane and type **Approvals** and select **My Approvals** under Service Desk	Governance Team	Review
11	Select the **State** from the dropdown and type **Requested** in the search bar and click **Enter**. The article waiting for approval will be listed down.  The approver can either approve from the above page by clicking on **Requested** (Right-click) or from **Approvals** tab under **Related List** in the article form (Explained in the next step)	Governance Team	Review
12	Click on the knowledge article and you will be directed to the article form. Go to the **Approval tab** under **Related List** Once approved, the article will be sent for the next level of review	Governance Team	Review
13	If the article needs to be rejected, click on **Requested** and select **Rejected** in the state field, and add **rejection comments** Clicking on **Reject,** the article will be automatically sent to the draft state	Governance Team	Review
14	Navigate to the left pane and type **Approvals** and select **My Approvals** under **Service Desk**	Reviewers	Review
15	Select **State** from the dropdown and type **Requested** in the search bar and click **Enter**. The article waiting for approval will be listed down 	Reviewers	Review

S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
	The approver can either approve from the above page by clicking on **Requested** (Right-click) or from **Approvals** tab under **Related List** in the article form (explained in the next step)		
16	Click on the knowledge article and you will be directed to the article form. In the article form, Go to the **Approval tab** under **Related List**  The approver can go to the **Approvals** Tab under **Related List** in the article form. Here as well, the approver can either right click on **Requested** and choose **Approve / Reject** from the list.  Another option is to click on **Requested**, which will open the approval form. Select the **State** as either **Approved / Rejected** and then click on **Approve / Reject** option.  Then the article is sent for the next level of approval i.e., to the Approvers	Reviewers	Review
17	Navigate to the left pane and type **Approvals** and select **My Approvals** under **Service Desk**	Approvers	Review
18	Select **State** from the dropdown and type **Requested** in the search bar and click **Enter**. The article waiting for approval will be listed down 	Approvers	Review

S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
	The approver can either approve from the above page by clicking on **Requested** (Right-click) or from **Approvals Tab** under **Related List** in the article form (Explained in the next step)		
19	Click on the knowledge article and you will be directed to the article form. In the article form, Go to the **Approval tab** under **Related List**  The approver can go to the **Approvals** Tab under **Related List** in the article form. Here as well, the approver can either right click on **Requested** and choose **Approve / Reject** from the list.  Another option is to click on **Requested**, which will open the approval form. Select the **State** as either **Approved / Rejected** and then click on **Approve / Reject** option.  Then the article is sent for the final level of approval i.e., to the Governance Team	Approvers	Review
20	Navigate to the left pane and type **Approvals** and select **My Approvals** under **Service Desk**	Governance Team	Review
21	Select **State** from the dropdown and type **Requested** in the search bar and click **Enter**. The article waiting for approval will be listed down  	Governance Team	Review

S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
	The approver can either approve from the above page by clicking on **Requested** (Right-click) or from **Approvals Tab** under **Related List** in the article form (Explained in the next step)		
22	Click on the knowledge article and you will be directed to the article form. In the article form, Go to the **Approval tab** under **Related List**  The approver can go to the **Approvals** Tab under **Related List** in the article form. Here as well, the approver can either right click on **Requested** and choose **Approve / Reject** from the list.  Another option is to click on **Requested**, which will open the approval form. Select the **State** as either **Approved / Rejected** and then click on **Approve / Reject** option.  	Governance Team	Review
23	The knowledge article will be Published automatically, once all 4 approvals are done. If at any one of the stages the article gets rejected, the article will move back to the draft state and will have to follow the same 4-level approval process.	NA	Published

6.2 Knowledge Maintenance – All Knowledge Bases

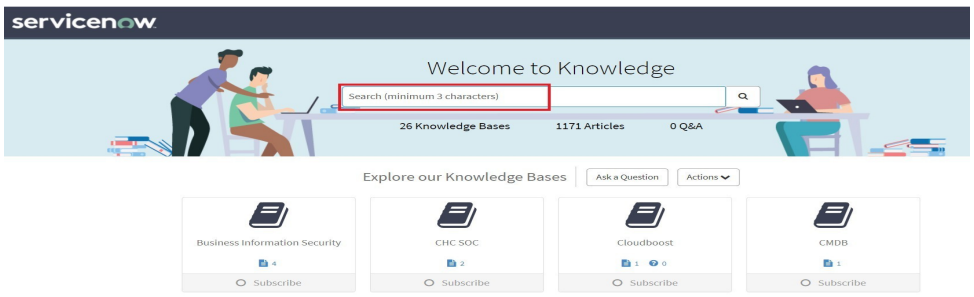
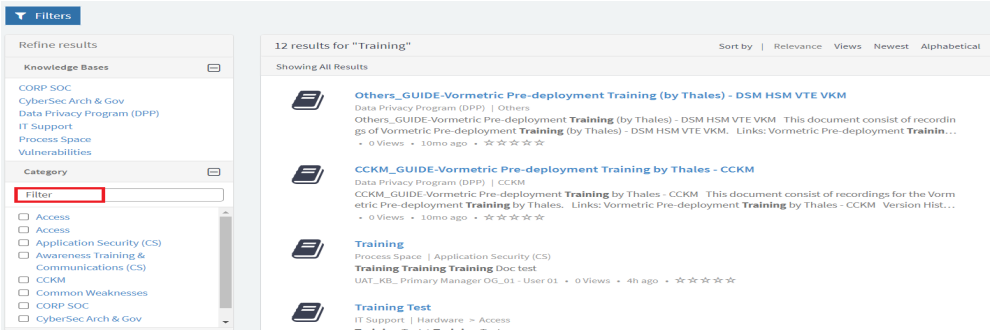
6.2.1 Providing Knowledge Feedback

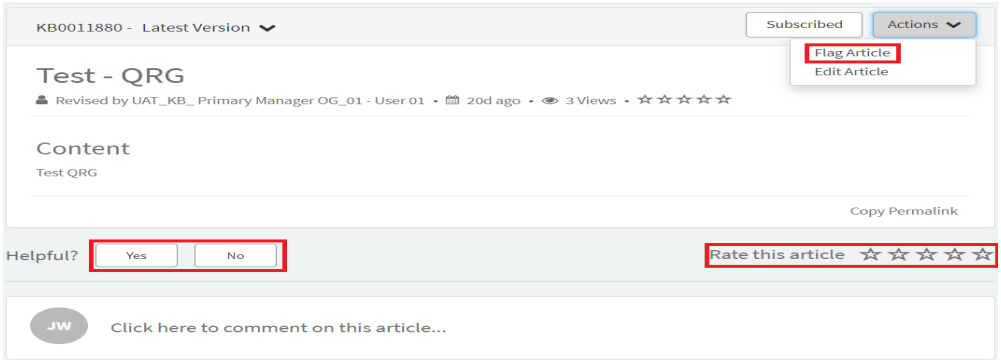
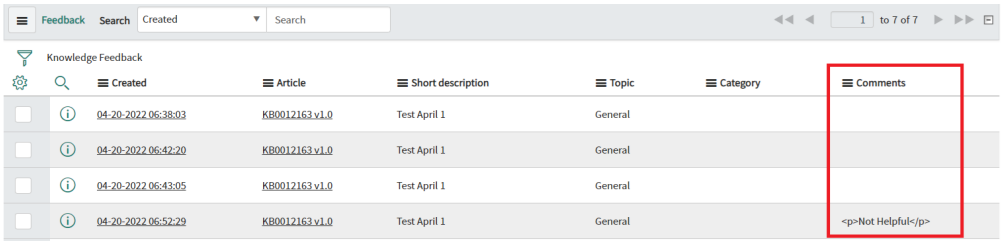
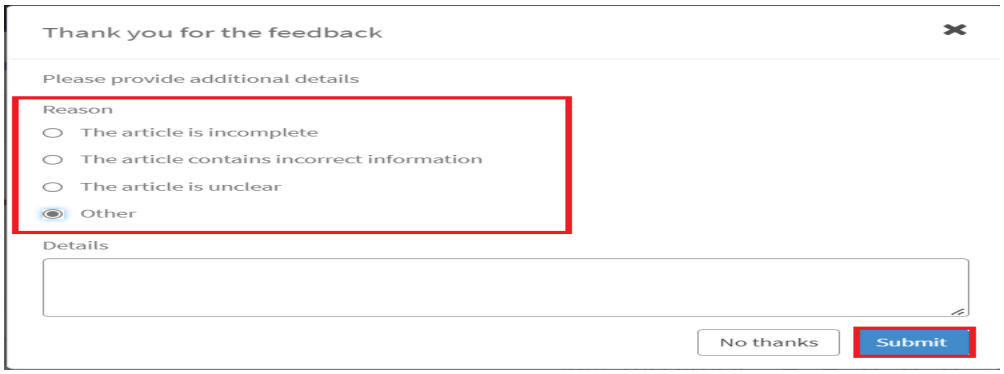
Feedback for knowledge articles can be submitted in these ways:

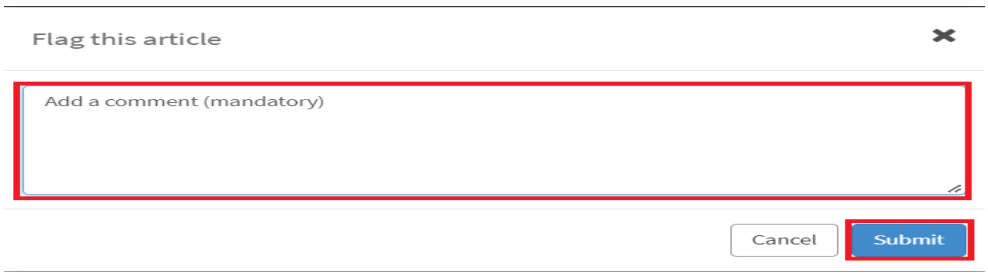
- Flag an article as incorrect or inappropriate.
- Provide a rating value for the article (1 to 5)
- Mark an article as helpful or not helpful.

Providing normal feedback will not create any feedback task and this feedback will be saved in the article form. Feedback tasks are generated only when poor feedback is provided from the Service Portal. Feedback task is generated only when the article is.

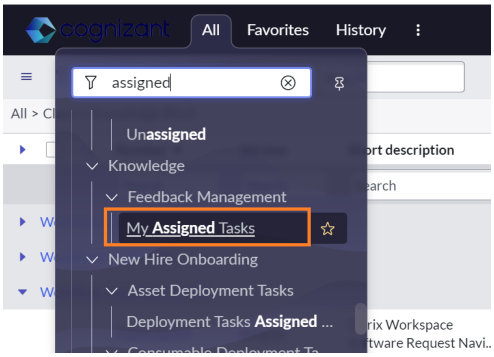
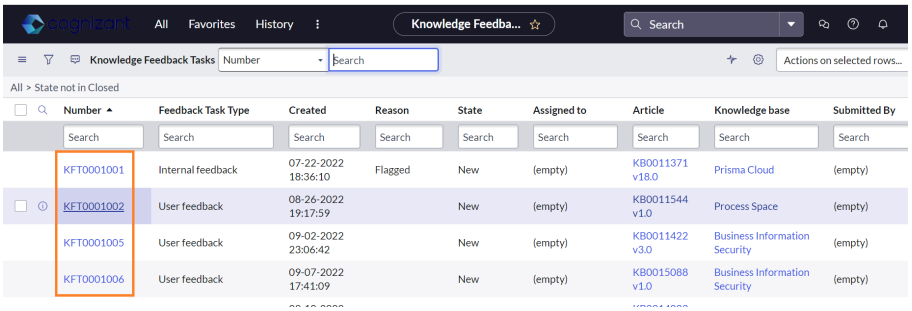
- Marked as Not Helpful
- Rated 3 or below 3
- AQI score is below the threshold (70)

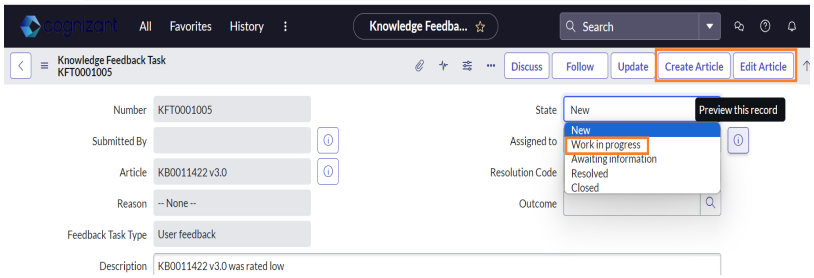
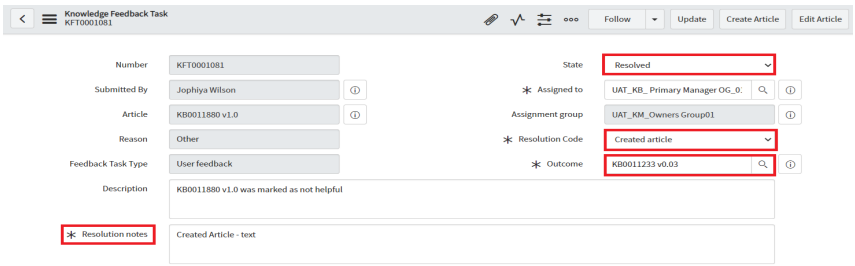
S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
1	Enter URL - https://ctsccprod.service-now.com/ss?id=kb_view2 and the user can log in to the service portal to search and share feedback on an article. 	Any user	Published
2	Use the search bar at the top of the page and type the keyword that you are looking for. For Example – Training	Any user	Published
3	Select the appropriate article • The user will be directed to the list of articles, matching the keywords • Apply filters in Knowledge Base, Category, and Rating (left pane) 	Any user	Published
4	There are options to flag, rate, mark the article as helpful/not, and add comments.	Any user	Published

S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
	 Providing normal feedback will not create any feedback task and this feedback will be saved in the article form 		
5	Click on **No / rate the article 3 stars or below** a pop box will appear asking for a specific reason for marking the article as not helpful / rating the article below 3.  Click on the relevant reason and click **Submit** post which the feedback task will be generated **Flag**, the user can also click on **Action** and select **Flag** post which a pop-up box will appear	Any user	Published

S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
	 Update the Comments box and click on Submit post which the feedback task will be generated. **A notification is triggered to the author, copying the ownership group, mentioning the reason for the feedback task - whether not helpful / flagged / poor rating whenever a feedback task is created.**		

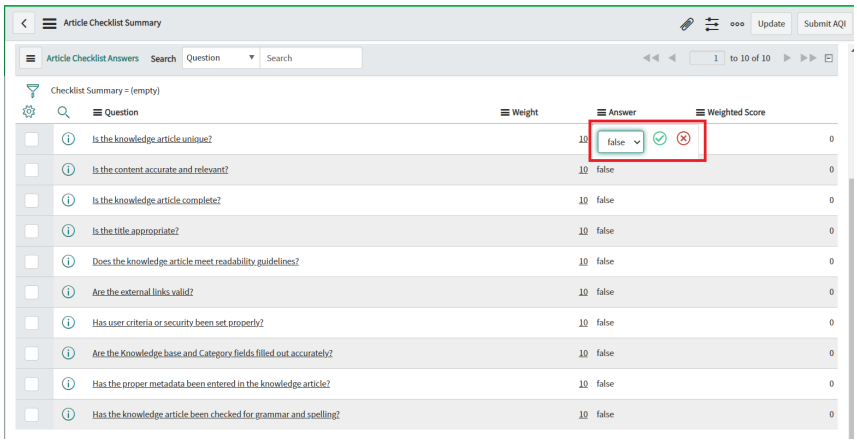
6.2.2 Responding to Knowledge Feedback Tasks

1	Go to **My Assigned Tasks** from the **Knowledge** module, to be directed to the list of articles for which feedback task has been generated. 	Author / Ownership Group Team	Published
2	Select the article for which the feedback has been raised, by clicking on the **Feedback Task number** starting with KFTXXXX. You will be directed to the Knowledge Feedback Task form 	Author / Ownership Group Team	Publish
3	Analyze the feedback provided and take necessary action – whether to create a new article or to enhance an existing article Move the feedback task to Work in Progress and Save.	Author / Ownership Group Team	Draft

			
4	To create a new article, click on **Create Article** This will direct the user to knowledge homepage, to create an article from the beginning. Refer Sec. 6.1 to follow the steps for knowledge article creation in the appropriate knowledge base.		
5	Once the article is published, go to **My Assigned Tasks** from the **Knowledge** module and navigate to the feedback task for which the article was newly created. • Select **Resolved** from the drop-down in the **State** field and add the **Resolution code** as **Created Article** from the dropdown and add the **Resolution notes** • Also, update the **Outcome** field with the newly created Knowledge Article number by clicking on the lens icon. Click **Update**. 	Author / Ownership Group Team	Published
6	• To enhance the article, as a result of feedback, click on **Edit Article** after moving the feedback task to **Work In Progress** • This will direct the author to the article form where the necessary corrections can be made. The article will move to the draft state and the author can republish the article after making the necessary corrections	Author / Ownership Group Team	Draft
7	• Once the article is approved and published, select the **My Assigned Tasks** and navigate to the feedback task form based on which the article was edited. • Select **Resolved** from the drop-down in the state field and add the Resolution code as **Updated Article** from the dropdown and add the Resolution notes and Click **Update.**	Author / Ownership Group Team	Published
8	• A notification will be sent to the feedback submitter post the article correction. • Based on the notification email, the feedback submitter will need to go to the feedback task, and there will be the option for the feedback submitter to review and accept or reject the updates made. • Once the submitter clicks on **Reject,** the task will go back to **Work in Progress** state. • If the submitter **accepts** the updates made, the task will be moved to **Close** state, and the feedback task will be closed	Feedback Submitter	Published/ Draft

6.2.3 Performing Article Quality Index (AQI)

Assess the quality of knowledge articles with the article quality index (AQI). The AQI helps maintain the consistent quality of knowledge articles attached to a knowledge base, where articles are written by various authors. The knowledge Manager performs an AQI review of knowledge articles attached to the knowledge base by answering the true or false questions in the checklist. The article quality is then scored based on the cumulative weight of all answers set to true in the checklist

S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
1	Login to the Service Now tool using Single Sign-on, navigate to the **Knowledge** module and click **Published** under **Articles**	Knowledge Manager	Published
2	Go to any published article and click on the option **Perform AQI** to be directed to the Article Checklist Summary form	Knowledge Manager	Published
3	Answer all 10 questions by clicking the green tick or red cross 	Knowledge Manager	Published
4	Click **Submit AQI**. The AQI score will be updated in the article. Feedback tasks will be generated when the AQI score is below the threshold (<70) **A notification is triggered on completion of an AQI audit to the author, copying the ownership group, along with the ratings and weightage.**	System	Published

6.2.4 Notifications

Based on the below notifications, knowledge maintenance activities can be triggered.

Notifications	Description
Article expiry	A notification is triggered to the author and ownership group informing them the article has expired post the article validity

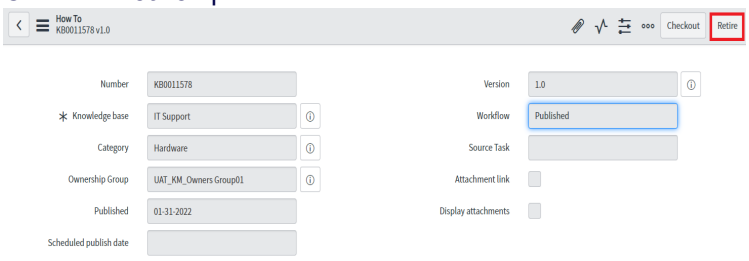
Before Article expiry	A notification is triggered to the author and ownership group + Knowledge Managers group (Governance Team), informing about the article expiration based on the following schedule: 1st Notification: 60 Days before article expiry 2nd Notification: 45 Days before article expiry 3rd Notification: 30 Days before the article expiry 4th Notification: 15 Days before article expiry

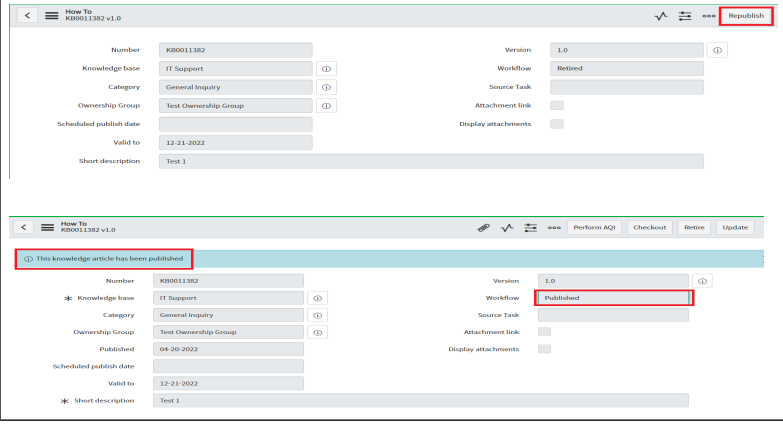
On the first day of each month, the application sends an email notification (screenshot below) to a list of authorized recipients (Author and Ownership Group) to remind them about articles that are scheduled to expire in the next month.

S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
1	Based on the email notification received, Knowledge managers will review the article Click on any article number and he/she will be directed to the article form	Ownership group Team / Knowledge Managers / Authors	Published / Expired
2	The task doer can decide to retire the article if the article is not fit for use directly from the article form. Add the rejection comments and click **Retire**, the article will move to the **Pending Retirement** state and will follow the retirement workflow which is explained in the next section.	Ownership group Team / Knowledge Managers / Authors	Published / Expired
3	Also, the task doer can click on the **checkout** option to make the necessary edits (if the article needs to be retained) 	Ownership group Team / Knowledge Managers / Authors	Published / Expired
4	After clicking on the **checkout option**, the article will move to the draft state. Fill in all the details in the form and click **Publish**, the approval workflow will be triggered similar to the Knowledge Creation Process.	Ownership group Team / Knowledge Managers / Authors	Published / Expired

6.3 Knowledge Retirement – All Knowledge Bases

If the knowledge item does not retain value, the knowledge article is retired. Retired knowledge articles are not available to users.

S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
1	Log in to the Service Now tool using Single Sign-on, navigate to the **Knowledge** module and click on **Published** under **Articles** and you will be directed to the list of published articles. Click on any published article from the list and you will be directed to the article form	Ownership group Team / Author	Published
2	Click the **Retire** option in the article form 	Ownership group Team / Author	Published
3	Add the reason for retirement in the article form and click **Retire** For the Known Error Article, we will have “Fix notes” instead of “Reason for Retirement”. Add the fix notes and click **Retire**	Ownership group Team / Author	Published
4	Navigate to the left pane and type Approvals and Select **My Approvals** under **Service Desk**	Ownership Group Managers	Pending Retirement
5	Select **State** from the dropdown and type **Requested** in the search bar and click **Enter**. The article waiting for Retirement approval will be listed down	Ownership Group Managers	Pending Retirement
6	Click on the knowledge article to be directed to the article form. In the article form, go to the **Approval** tab under the Related List The approver can either approve from the list view page by clicking on **Requested** (right-click) or can approve from **Approvals** tab under **Related List** in the article form	Ownership Group Managers	Pending Retirement
7	Knowledge article will be retired automatically, once the approver clicks **Approve**. If the approver clicks **Reject**, the article is moved to the published stage	System	Retired / Published
8	If the retired article needs to be republished, Knowledge Manager can navigate to the Knowledge module and click on **Retired.** The retired articles will be listed down	Knowledge Manager	Retired
9	Click on any article and navigate to the article form	Knowledge Manager	Retired
10	Click on **Republish** option and the article will move to the published state	Knowledge Manager	Published

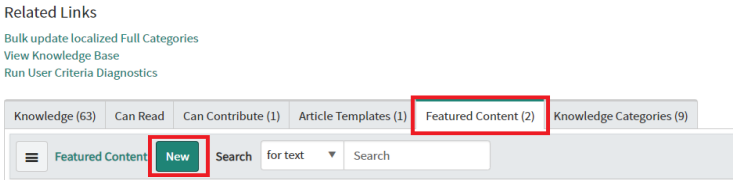
S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
			

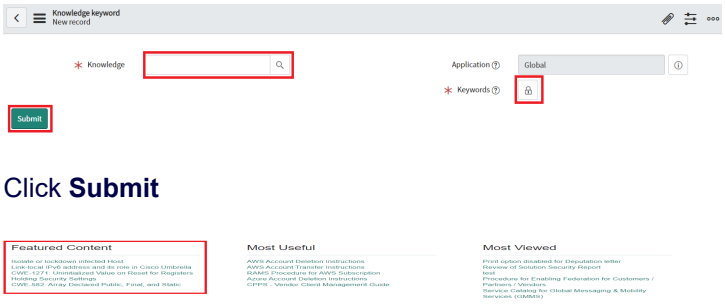
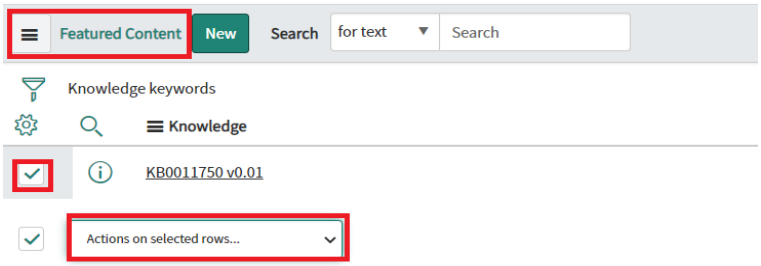
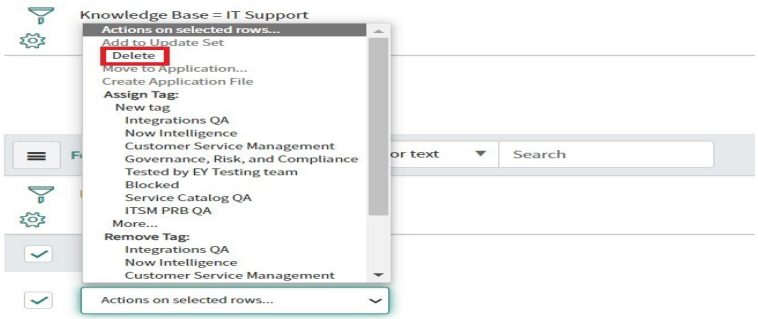
7.0 Additional Features

7.1 Adding a knowledge article to Featured Content

Add a knowledge article to appear in the Featured content section of the knowledge homepage and at the top of the knowledge search results page.

Adding an article to featured content requires associating an article with specific keywords. You can search for a keyword in the knowledge service portal or search results page to display articles in the **Featured Content** section or at the top of the knowledge search results list.

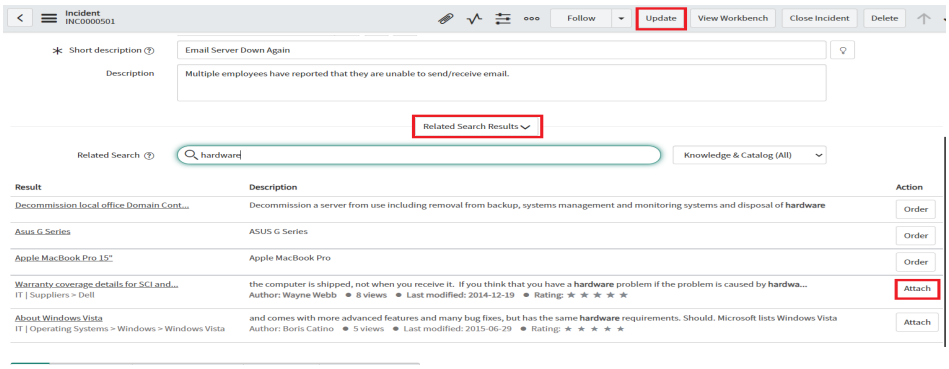
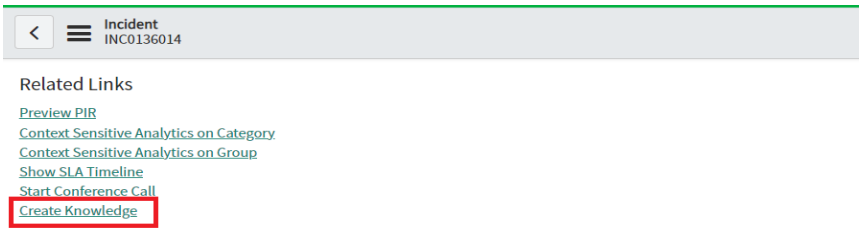
S. No.	Activity	Owner	State
1	Navigate to the Knowledge module and select the **Knowledge Base** under Knowledge	Knowledge Manager	Published
2	Select any one Knowledge Base from the list and navigate to the form	Knowledge Manager	Published
3	Scroll down and click on **Featured Content** under **Related List** and click **New** 	Knowledge Manager	Published
4	Search for and select the desired article in the **Knowledge** field, if you know the article number, you can search for the article directly	Knowledge Manager	Published

S. No.	Activity	Owner	State
5	Click the lookup icon to open the Knowledge keywords list and select the keyword to add to the article and add the keywords to the article  Click **Submit** 	Knowledge Manager	Published
6	If the article needs to be removed from featured content, navigate to the respective knowledge base, scroll down to the **Featured Content** tab in **Related List,** and click on the **check box** of the article that needs to be removed  Select **Delete** from the dropdown, the article will be removed from the Featured Content  	Knowledge Manager	Published

7.2 Finding and Using within the Incident form

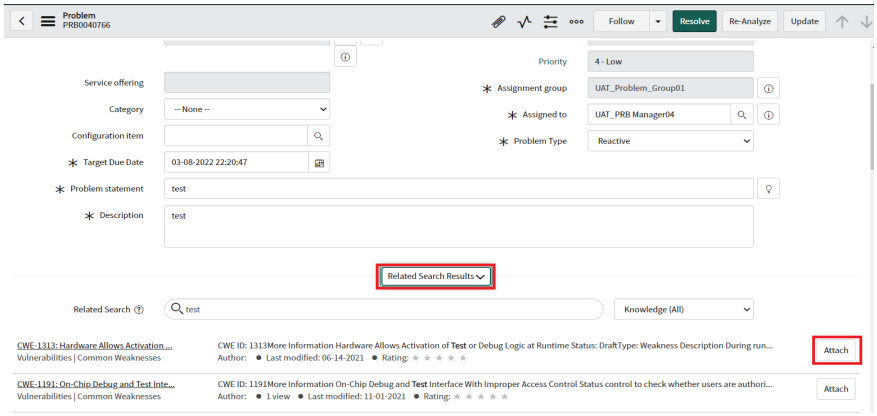
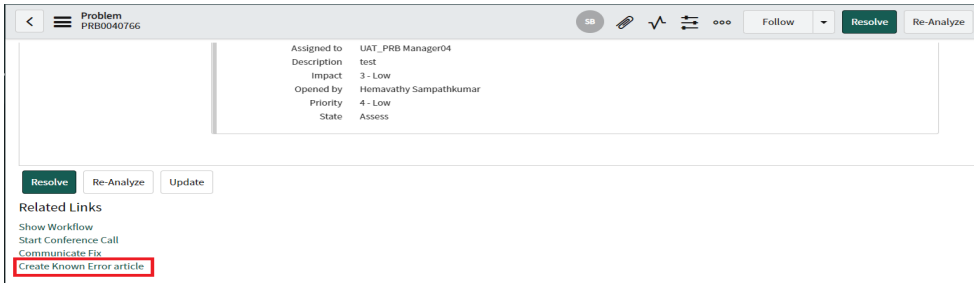
Attach a knowledge article to an incident to solve issues quickly by going through the in-depth troubleshooting steps and other detailed information in the article.

If there are no articles, knowledge article can be created by using a link at the bottom of the incident form

S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
1	Log in and navigate to the **Incidents** module	Analyst	New
2	Open an active incident record. Scroll down and click on **Related Search Results** Click **Attach** for the Knowledge article that you want to attach with the incident record. Click on the **Update** button 	Analyst	New
4	Scroll down and click on **Create Knowledge** under **Related Links** if there are no articles present to attach  This will direct you to the KCS article which will follow the creation and approval workflow.	Analyst	New

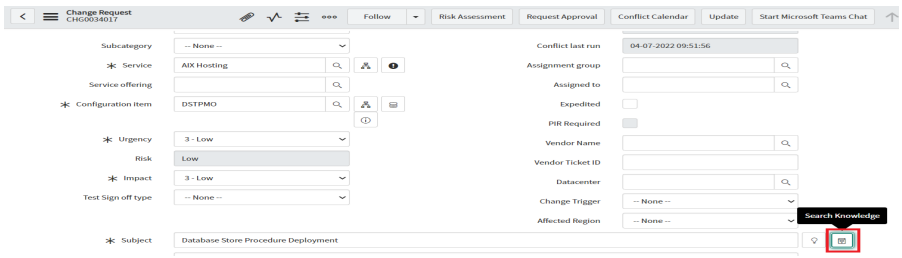
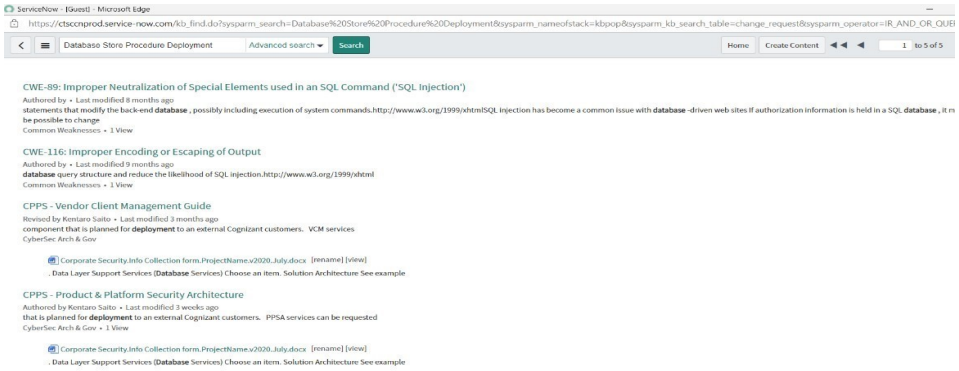
7.3 Finding and Using within Problem form

S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
1	Navigate to the **Problem** module and click on **Open** under **Problems**	Analyst	New
2	Open an active problem record. Scroll down and click on **Related Search Results**	Analyst	New
3	Click **Attach** for the Knowledge article that you want to attach with the Problem record. Click on the **Update** button	Analyst	New

S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
			
4	Scroll down and click on **Create Known Error Article** under **Related Links** if there are no articles present to attach  This will direct you to the **Known Error** article which will follow the Create, approve workflow.	Analyst	Draft

7.4 Finding and Using within Change form

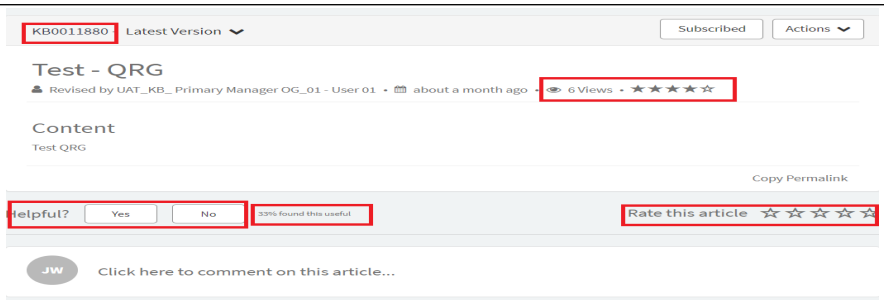
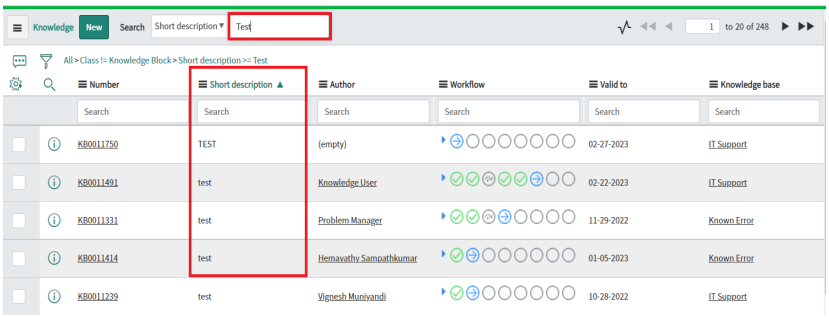
S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
1	Navigate to the **Change** module and Click on **All** under Change	ITIL role	Any state from New to Review
2	Click on the **Change number** from the list of change tickets reflected on the page and open the change form	ITIL role	Any state from New to Review
3	Click on the **Search Knowledge** Icon highlighted to search Knowledge and you will be directed to the list of related articles.	ITIL role	Any state from New to

S. No.	Activity	Owner	Stage
	 Click on the **article** which matches the short description, and you will be directed to the article. 		Review
4	Click on **Attach to Change Request** option to attach the article	ITIL role	Any state from New to Review

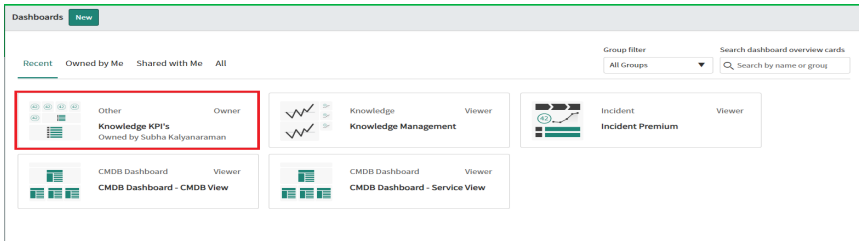
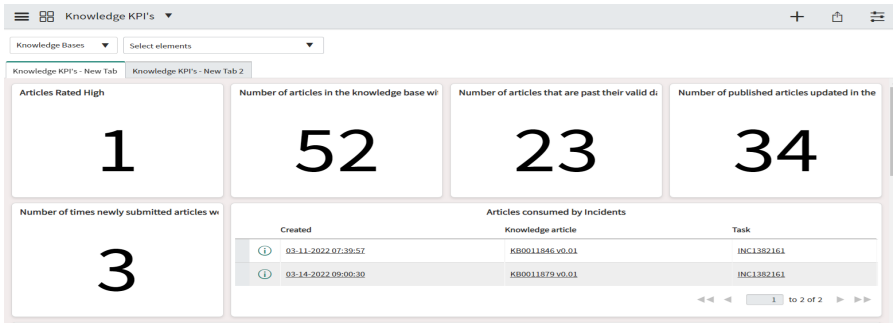
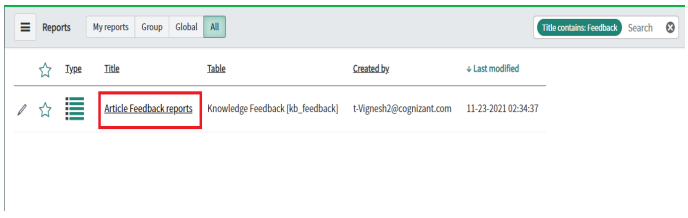
7.5 Knowledge Search

Knowledge articles can also be searched through multiple options.

Sl No.	Options	Activity
1	From Service Portal	• Enter URL - https://ctsccprod.service-now.com/ss?id=kb_view2 and the user can log in to the service portal to search for the article. • Use the search bar at the top of the page and type the keyword that you are looking for. For Example – Training • Select the appropriate article. The user will be directed to the list of articles, matching the keywords • Apply filters in Knowledge Base, Category, and Rating (left pane) • The users will be able to see the below view of articles from the service portal

		 From the portal, the consumer can see the number of views, % of people who have marked the article as helpful, and star ratings and can also add feedback.
2	From Knowledge module	• Type Article in the navigation search bar and click on All • Select Short Description in the dropdown and type the keyword of the article that you are looking into (For example – Test) and articles with similar keywords will be listed down.  From the knowledge module, below article view can be seen. Different fields, Approver's, and reviewer's names are also visible from the module view which is not visible from the portal view. Adding feedback is possible only through the service portal not through the knowledge module.
3	From Incident form	• Navigate to the **Incident** module • Click on **Open** under Incidents and select any incident record listed • Scroll down and Click on **Related Search Results**, search results appear
4	From Problem form	• Navigate to the **Problem** module • Click on **Open** under Problems and select any problem record listed • Scroll down and Click on **Related Search Results**, search results appear

7.6 Reports and Dashboards

S. No.	Activity	Owner
1	Navigate to the **Knowledge** module and type Dashboard in the search bar Click on **Dashboard** under Performance Analytics	Knowledge Admin / Knowledge Manager
2	The below screen will be visible when he/she will click on the Dashboard  and Knowledge admin will be able to see the below page with the KPIs requested. 	Knowledge Admin / Knowledge Manager
3	For reports, type **Reports** in the navigation bar and click on the **View/Run** option	Knowledge Admin / Knowledge Manager
	Type in the Reports name in the search bar to view the configured reports For example, type **feedback** in the search bar and click **Enter.** The feedback report will be listed down 	Knowledge Admin / Knowledge Manager

7.7 Creating a new Knowledge Base

S. No.	Activity	Owner
1	Navigate to the left pane in the Knowledge Management module and type **Knowledge Base** and select **Knowledge Base**. Existing knowledge bases will be listed. Click on **New** to create a new knowledge base.	Knowledge Admin
2	Fill in all the fields in the form and click **Submit** **Title**, Unique name for the knowledge base. **Article Validity**, Number of default days articles will be valid after their created date. **The icon** is an image that provides a visual reference to describe the knowledge base. This image is displayed next to all articles from this knowledge base on the article search results page. **Disable commenting**, Option to disable commenting. If selected, users cannot comment on articles in the knowledge base **Disable suggesting**, Option to disable edit suggestions. If selected, users cannot suggest edits to articles in the knowledge base **Disable category editing**, Option to disable editing of knowledge categories. If selected, only knowledge managers can add or edit knowledge categories for the knowledge base. **Enable blocks,** Option to enable the knowledge blocks feature. If selected, you can create knowledge blocks to add to knowledge articles within a knowledge base. **Checklist,** Checklist to evaluate the quality of articles in the knowledge base. **Application**, the Application scope of the knowledge base. Note: This field is automatically set to the application selected in the application picker. **Owner**, The user responsible for the knowledge base. **Managers**, Users who perform administrative functions on the knowledge base. **Publish workflow**, the workflow for publishing the articles in the knowledge base. **Retire workflow**, the workflow for retiring the articles in the knowledge base. **Active**, Option to indicate that the knowledge base is active **Description**, A short description to describe the knowledge base Set default knowledge field values from the dropdown and click **Submit**	

8.0 Acronyms

Acronym	Description
ITSM	Information Technology Service Management
KM	Knowledge Management

PPT	PowerPoint Presentation
IT	Information technology
SOP	Standard Operating Procedure
KEDB	Known Error Data Base
KE	Known Error
AQI	Article Quality Index
KCS	Knowledge Centered Service
FAQ	Frequently Asked Questions
QMS	Quality Management System
SKMS	Service Knowledge Management System

9.0 Definitions

Please refer to the Common Terms Glossary Link for a comprehensive list of terms and definitions. All key terms to this standard are below.

Term	Description
Knowledge Management	The practice of maintaining and improving the effective, efficient, and convenient use of information and knowledge across an organization
Knowledge	Information combined with rules, i.e., information combined with experience, interpretation, and reflection
Knowledge Base	An information repository that provides a means for information and knowledge to be collected, organized, shared, searched, and utilized
Known Error	A problem that has a documented root cause and a workaround. Known errors are created and managed throughout their lifecycle by problem management.
KEDB	A database that records and tracks all known errors
Knowledge Article	Captures a key facet of Knowledge using the appropriate attributes, and documents the relevant information for aiding future decisions or actions
Contributor	A contributor is an IT user who has proven proficiency in creating and reworking knowledge articles. A contributor can create, edit, and publish knowledge articles for an internal IT audience
Publisher	A publisher is a contributor who can also create and rework public-facing knowledge content on websites and customer port
Published Document	A document that has already been published in the current/existing Knowledge Management System

10.0 Change Log

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<tr><th>Version Number</th><th colspan="4">Changes Made</th></tr>
<tr><td>V1.0.0</td><td colspan="4">Initial baseline created on 08-12-2022 by Subha Kalyanaraman</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="3">V X.Y.Z</td><td colspan="4"><Please refer to the configuration control tool/change item status form if the details of changes are maintained separately. If not, the template given below needs to be followed></td></tr>
<tr><td>Section No.</td><td>Changed By</td><td>Effective Date</td><td>Changes Effected</td></tr>
<tr><td>All sections</td><td>Subha K</td><td>2-2-2024</td><td>Updated End user knowledge base details
Updated screenshots as per UTAH upgrade
Updated broken links</td></tr>
<tr><td></td><td>All Sections</td><td>Subha K</td><td>2-11-2025</td><td>Validated and no changes</td></tr>
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